

The Family Readiness *Gap Check*

Twelve questions about what the people who love you could actually find tomorrow morning — if you were unreachable and could not explain anything. Answer honestly. Nobody is grading this.

HOW TO USE THIS

Tick the box only if the answer is a confident yes — meaning someone else could do it today, without calling you, guessing, or hunting. A "probably" is a no. Total your ticks at the bottom.

ONE People

- ☐ Someone other than you knows exactly who to call first in an emergency — by name and number.
Not "they'd figure it out." A specific person they could reach in ninety seconds.
- ☐ There is a named backup if that first person is unreachable, travelling, or is the emergency.
- ☐ Anyone who depends on you — a child, a parent, a pet — has a named caretaker who already knows they are named.
Being named in your head does not count. They have to know.

TWO Documents

- ☐ Someone could locate your signed will, trust, power of attorney, or advance directive — the physical originals, not a copy or a memory of signing one.
- ☐ Your insurance policies could be identified by company and policy number without opening your mail.
- ☐ Property documents — deed, title, lease, mortgage — have a known location.

THREE Access

- ☐ Someone could get into your home and knows where the spare key or code lives.
- ☐ Your primary email account has a documented recovery path a trusted person could follow.
Email is the master key. Whoever holds it can reset almost everything else.
- ☐ You have set a legacy contact or inactive-account plan on at least one major platform — Apple, Google, Meta.

FOUR Money & continuity

- ☐ Someone could list which banks hold your accounts — institutions only, no numbers or passwords needed.
- ☐ Recurring obligations that would default within thirty days — rent, mortgage, utilities, insurance — are written down somewhere findable.
- ☐ If you went quiet for four days, someone would notice and act, rather than assume you were busy.
This is the question people living alone most often fail — and it is the one that determines whether any of the others get used in time.

YOUR TOTAL — COUNT THE TICKS

0-3

WIDE OPEN

Little is transferable yet. Common, and fixable in an afternoon.

4-7

TYPICAL

You are where most organised people sit. The gaps are in access and continuity.

8-10

WELL AHEAD

Real work done. What is missing is one written map, not more effort.

11-12

GENUINELY READY

Rare. Confirm your people can still act on it, then review yearly.

WHAT TO DO WITH YOUR SCORE

Four moves, *in this order*

If you do nothing else after reading this page, do the first two. They take under an hour together and they close the widest gaps most households have.

01 Name two people, out loud

A first call and a backup. Then tell them. The single most common failure is a plan that exists only in the head of the person it is meant to protect. A two-minute conversation converts a private intention into something someone can act on.

02 Write down where things are, not what they are

Not the contents of your will — the drawer it is in. Not the account number — the bank's name. Locations are safe to write down and are the thing people actually cannot guess. This distinction is the whole trick.

03 Fix email first

Your primary email resets everything else. Set up recovery, then set a legacy contact on your Apple or Google account. Ten minutes here is worth more than an hour spent anywhere else on this list.

04 Decide how someone would know

A standing check-in with one person — a weekly call, a shared calendar note, an agreed "if I miss two of these, come round." Every other item on this page assumes somebody noticed in time. That assumption is usually the weakest part of the plan.

THE RULE THAT MAKES THIS SAFE

Write down *pointers*, never *credentials*. Where the document lives, not what it says. Which bank, not the account number. Which password manager, not the master password. A pointer is useless to a stranger and invaluable to your family. A credential is the reverse. Follow that one rule and you can leave this material somewhere genuinely findable — which is the only place it does any good.

When you want the full map

This page shows you the gaps. **The Finder's Book** is the 49-page organiser that closes them — fillable and printable, built entirely on the pointer rule above, with sections for people, documents, access, money, property, digital life, and memorial wishes. You can see twelve real interior pages before deciding.

[Read more and preview the pages →](#)

This is not legal, medical, or financial advice. The Family Readiness Gap Check is a self-assessment tool for personal record-keeping. It is not a will, trust, contract, power of attorney, or advance directive, and it confers no authority over any account, property, or medical decision. Consult an attorney, licensed medical professional, or licensed financial advisor about anything with legal, medical, or financial effect.